

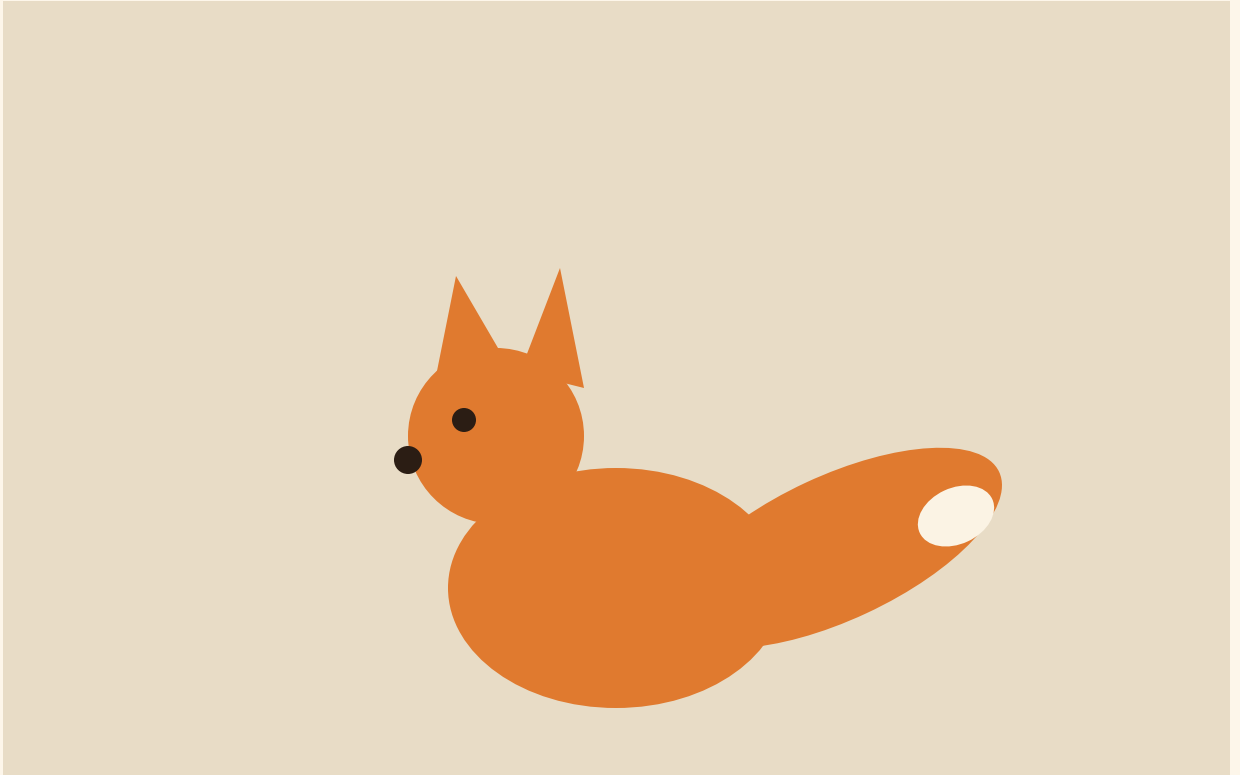
The Clockmaker's Fox



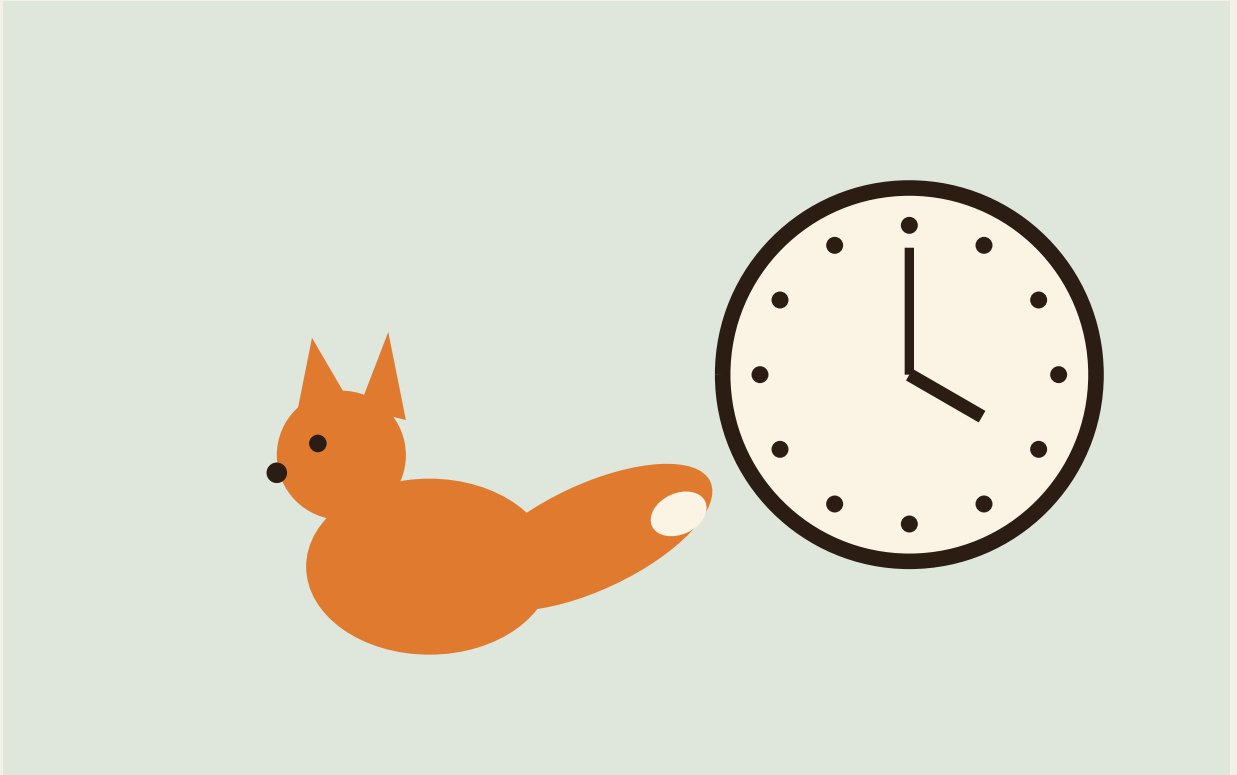
A PICTURE BOOK



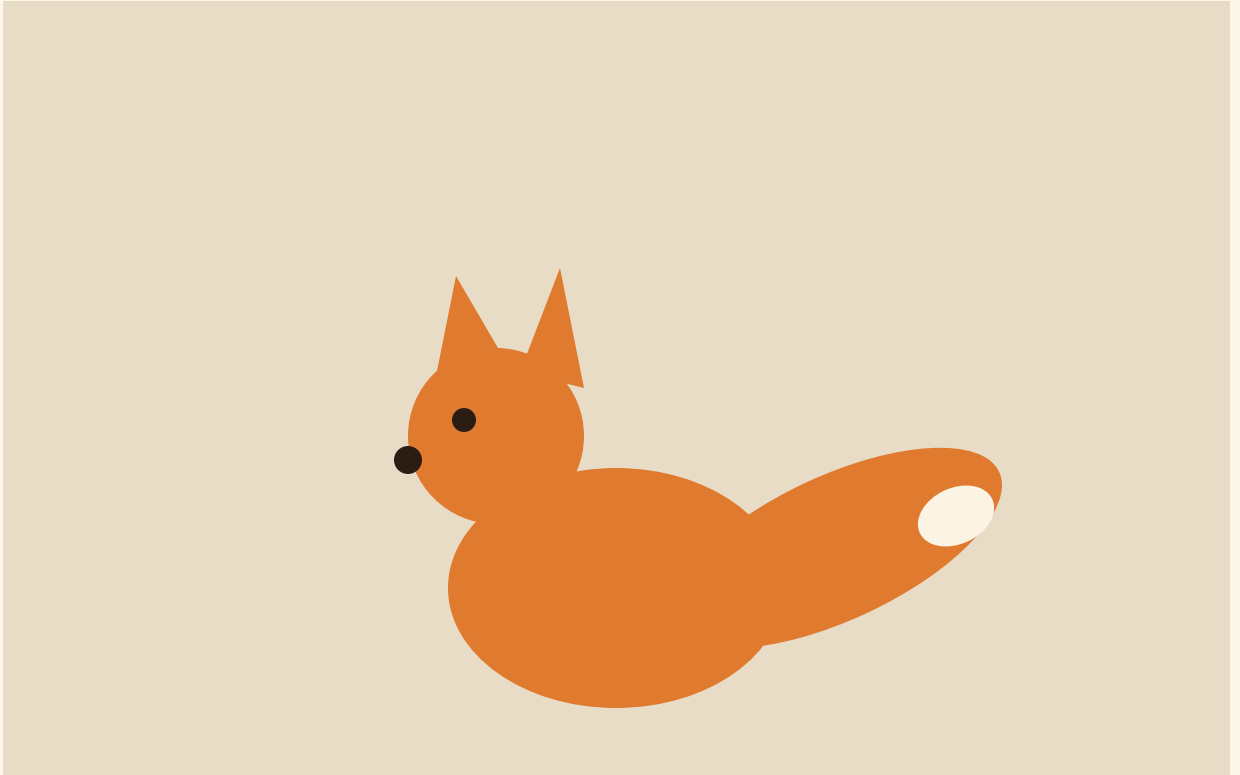
In a town where every roof had a weathervane, there lived an old clockmaker named Ada, who mended clocks that had forgotten how to tick.



One winter night, a small red fox crept into her workshop. It was not looking for food. It was looking for the sound.



Tick, went the clocks on the wall. Tock, went the clocks on the shelf. The fox sat very still and listened with both ears.



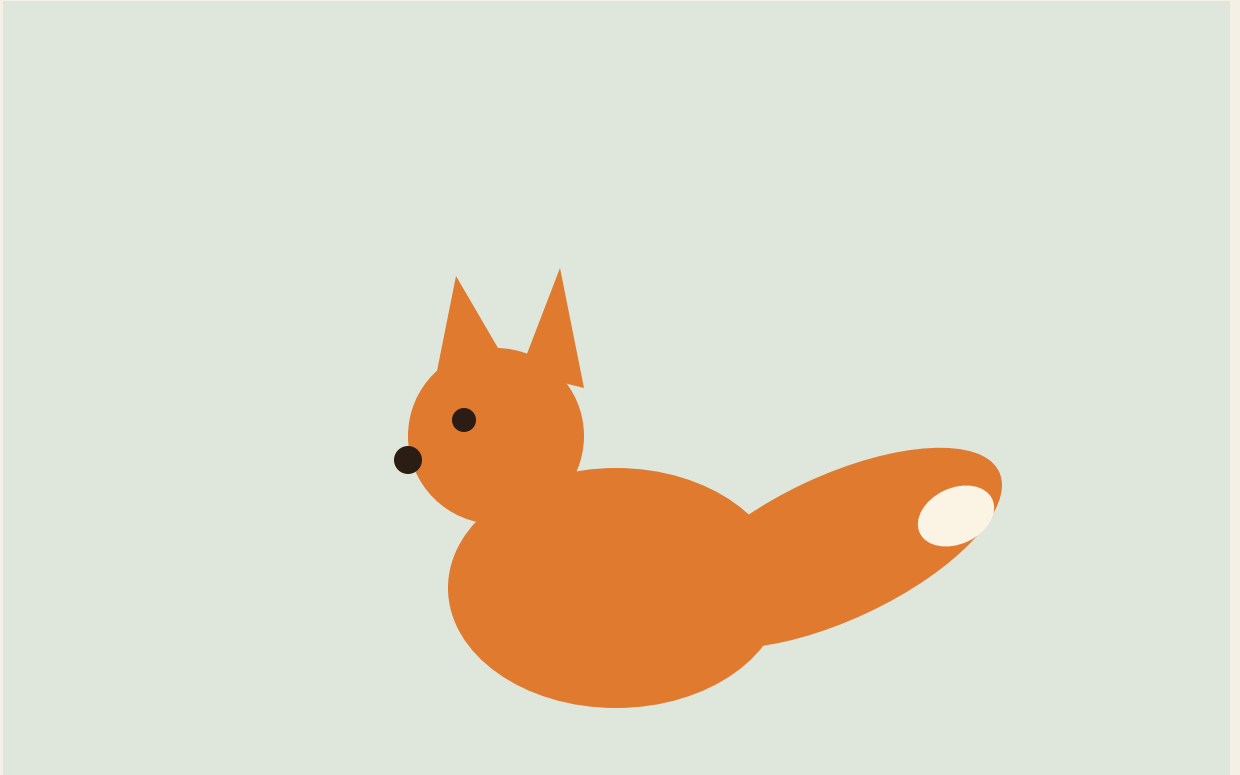
“You may stay,” said Ada, “if you help me listen.” So the fox learned which clocks were healthy and which ones limped.



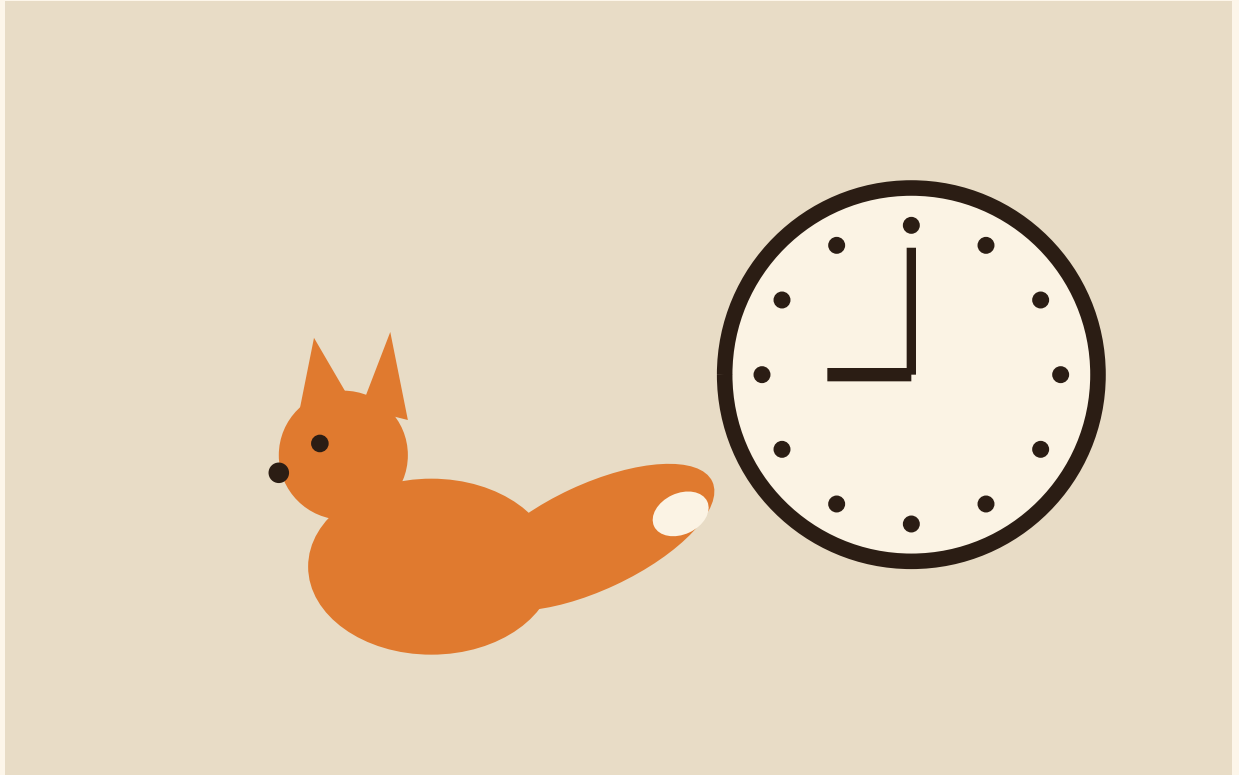
A clock with a sticky spring went tick... ..tock. A clock with a loose gear went ticktickticktock. The fox could hear them all.



Soon people came from every street. “The fox can hear what’s wrong,” they said, and they brought their quiet, broken clocks.

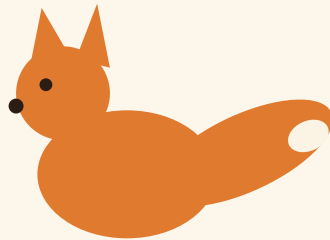


When spring came, the fox stood at the open door for a long time. The forest was ticking too, in its own green way.



“Go on,” said Ada. “But come back when something stops.”
And every winter, when the town clocks grew slow, the fox
came home.

The End





For everyone who listens closely.